

BOOK SUMMARY



The Psychology of Money

Timeless Lessons on Wealth, Greed, and Happiness

MORGAN HOUSEL

2020

What This Book Is About

Structurally, this is not one long argument you have to follow from front to back. It is twenty short, standalone essays, most of them only a handful of pages, each built around a single behavioural idea about money. Housel says outright that you can read them out of order and lose nothing — there is no thread of logic strung tightly chapter to chapter, only the same theme returned to from twenty different angles.

What it is not: this is not a book of tactics. There is no advice here on which fund to buy, how to budget, how to read a balance sheet, or how to time a market. If you come to it looking for a financial plan, you will not find one. That absence is deliberate — Housel's claim is that the technical side of money is the easy part, and it is not where most people go wrong.

The message, stated plainly: doing well with money is not mostly a matter of what you know. It is a matter of how you behave — and behaviour is shaped by things far outside a spreadsheet: the family you were raised in, the decade you came of age in, your relationship to luck, fear, and ego. **Good investing is not necessarily about earning the highest returns; it is about earning pretty good returns you can stick with for the longest period of time.**

The Man Behind It

Housel studied economics at Washington and Lee University. It is a conventional enough starting point for someone who ends up writing about money, but what actually shaped this book was not the classroom — it was what came after. He worked as an analyst and columnist at the Motley Fool, and later as a columnist at the Wall Street Journal and a partner at the venture firm Collaborative Fund, writing continuously and publicly about markets and personal finance for over a decade.

That work put him in a position to watch, at close range and in enormous volume, how ordinary people actually behaved with their money — not how economic models said they should behave. That gap, between the tidy rationality assumed by finance theory and the messy, emotional reality he kept observing in real people, is the thing this whole book is trying to explain.

He does not present himself as a stock-picker, an analyst with a forecasting track record, or someone claiming special technical insight into markets — and that absence of a credentialing claim is consistent with the book's own argument: that psychology, not technical skill, is the deciding factor in most people's financial outcomes.

Beyond this book, he is known for his continued writing on investor behaviour and history, including later work extending these same ideas.

Where This Book Came From

The book was published in September 2020, but its origin sits a few years earlier: in 2018, Housel wrote a short essay, also titled "The Psychology of Money," that spread widely online. The book is that essay, unfolded — the same core observations given room to breathe across twenty chapters.

He was writing against a finance industry culture that treats money as a field of maths and spreadsheets: a domain of formulas, ratios, and optimization, where the "correct" decision could in principle be calculated. Housel's contention is that this framing quietly ignores the actual terrain — that money decisions are made by people carrying ego, envy, fear, and a lifetime of experiences that a formula cannot see.



*Twenty chapters, one idea, returned to again and again
from a different direction each time.*

**Doing well with money has little
to do with how smart you are
and everything to do with how
you behave — and behaviour is
shaped by personal history, ego,
and the ability to stay in the
game long enough for com-
pounding to work.**

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No One's Crazy

People make money decisions that look irrational to you but make complete sense given the world they've personally lived through.

Your own experiences with money make up maybe 0.00000001% of what has happened in the world, but maybe 80% of how you think the world works. Housel opens here because it explains something that otherwise looks like stupidity: two people can look at the same set of facts about investing and come to opposite, deeply-held conclusions, and neither of them is a fool. Someone who came of age during a market crash and someone who came of age during a boom will, for the rest of their lives, carry entirely different assumptions about what money can be trusted to do — not because one has done the homework and the other hasn't, but because they were each taught by different decades.

\$2M+

Difference in lifetime stock market outcomes Housel calculates between someone born in 1970 versus 1950, purely from the sequence of returns each generation happened to live through

He tells the story of Ronald Read, a janitor and gas station attendant who quietly amassed an \$8 million portfolio through decades of saving and patience, alongside stories of highly trained financial professionals who went spectacularly broke. The point is not that Read was smarter. It is that **financial outcomes are driven by behaviour, not intelligence**, and behaviour is downstream of the specific, narrow slice of history each of us happened to live through.

Your personal experiences with money make up maybe 0.00000001% of what's happened in the world, but maybe 80% of how you think the world works.

So when someone makes a money decision that seems crazy to you — refusing to invest, gambling on lottery tickets, hoarding cash — Housel's instruction is to remember they are not idiots. They are working from a different set of lived experiences than you are, and within that set of experiences, their decision is reasonable.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Notice, rather than act: before judging someone else's financial choice as foolish, ask what personal history might make that choice make sense. Housel is asking you to extend the same reasoning to yourself — your own convictions about money are also a product of your specific history, not objective truth.

Luck & Risk

Luck and risk are siblings — both are proof that life is too complex to let 100% of your actions determine 100% of your outcomes.

Housel tells the story of Bill Gates, who attended one of the only high schools in the world in 1968 with a computer, giving him an almost freakishly lucky head start — and pairs it with the story of his childhood friend Kent Evans, equally brilliant, who died in a mountaineering accident before he could see any of it pay off. Same skill, same opportunity, wildly different outcomes, and the difference was luck and risk, not effort.

His caution: be careful who you praise and admire, and who you disparage — including yourself. Not everything that looks like the product of skill is skill, and not everything that looks like the result of bad decisions is a bad decision. **Some people gamble their way to riches; others do everything right and still lose.** Because you cannot cleanly separate luck from skill by looking at outcomes alone, Housel's advice is to focus less on specific individuals and case studies, and more on broad patterns.

Nothing is as good or as bad as it seems.

He extends this to how we judge failure, too — the line between "bold" and "reckless" is often invisible until after the outcome is known, and outcomes are contaminated by luck on both sides.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel prescribes humility, specifically: when things go well for you, acknowledge the role luck played rather than crediting it entirely to skill; when judging others' failures, extend the same allowance. Focus on broad patterns of behaviour rather than

treating any single person's outcome — good or bad — as a reliable blueprint.

Never Enough

The hardest financial skill is getting the goalpost to stop moving — social comparison is a game that can never be won.

Housel opens with the story of Rajat Gupta, who rose from an orphaned childhood to become CEO of McKinsey and sit on the boards of Goldman Sachs and Procter & Gamble — already extraordinarily wealthy by any reasonable measure — and then went to prison for insider trading, chasing still more money he did not need. Beside him he places Bernie Madoff, who was already legitimately rich before he built the fraud that destroyed him.

The lesson Housel draws is not about greed as a character flaw, but about a specific failure of calibration: both men had "enough" by any external measure and could not recognise it internally. **The ability to do nothing when your desired result doesn't materialise is an important skill in investing** — and so is the ability to stop wanting more once you already have plenty.

2

The two things Housel says are hardest to accept once you have enough: that "enough" is not too little, and that it will not always beat the returns of those still reaching for more

Social comparison is the engine behind this, in Housel's account — because the person you're measuring yourself against always has a little more, "enough" is a moving target unless you consciously decide to fix it in place.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel's explicit prescription: define what "enough" means for you, in advance, and hold that line — especially against the pull of comparing your position to someone who has more. He names specific behaviours to guard against: reputational risk, financial risk, and the risk to family and friends are never worth chasing an amount of money beyond what you need.

Confounding Compounding

Compounding only works if you give an asset years to grow — good investing is about earning decent returns you can sustain, not the highest returns.

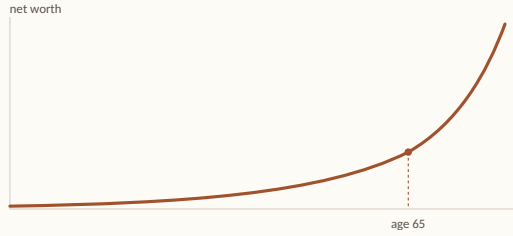
Of Warren Buffett's roughly \$84.5 billion net worth at the time of writing, Housel points out that \$81.5 billion of it arrived after his 65th birthday. Buffett is a good investor — but his real superpower, in Housel's telling, is that he has been a good investor for three-quarters of a century. Had he started investing in his 30s and retired at 60 like most people, almost no one would have heard of him.

His skill is investing, but his secret is time.

The chapter's point is that compounding is deeply unintuitive because it does not look impressive at the start — the growth in early years is small and unremarkable, and only becomes extraordinary very late, once the base is large. This is why people underrate it: **the best financial strategy is one you can stick with for decades**, even if it looks unspectacular for most of that time, rather than one that promises faster growth but that you can't hold through downturns.

30

Of Buffett's 90-plus years of investing, the number of years after which the overwhelming majority of his wealth was created



BUFFETT'S NET WORTH OVER TIME — FLAT FOR DECADES, THEN COMPOUNDING
TURNS SHARPLY LATE

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel wants you to stop optimising for the highest possible annual return and start optimising for a "pretty good" return you can sustain without interruption for the longest period of time. He is explicit that this reframes the goal of investing away from picking the best performer and toward simply not being forced to stop.

Getting Wealthy vs. Staying Wealthy

Getting money requires risk-taking and optimism; keeping money requires humility and the fear that what you've built can be taken away.

Housel draws on the trader Jesse Livermore, who made and lost several fortunes across his life, ultimately dying by suicide after his final collapse — as an illustration that the skills which build wealth are not the same skills that preserve it. Getting money demands optimism, boldness, and a willingness to take risk. **Staying wealthy requires the opposite: frugality, and an acceptance that some of what you made was luck, so past success cannot be relied upon to repeat.**

He identifies "survival" as the single most important trait for compounding financial success over time — not high returns, not brilliance, but simply staying in the game long enough for growth to accumulate. This means planning explicitly for the possibility that your plans will go wrong.

Good investing is not necessarily about earning the highest returns. It's about earning pretty good returns that you can stick with.

GETTING

optimism

risk-taking

boldness

STAYING

humility

frugality

fear of loss

Housel is candid that this can look, from the outside, like paranoia — holding more caution and more of a buffer than the good years seem to justify. He argues this is precisely the point: the caution is what lets you survive the years that aren't good.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel's prescription: build financial plans around surviving, not optimising. Concretely, this means holding onto more safety margin than seems necessary, being financially humble in good times, and never assuming that a run of good decisions guarantees the next one will also work out.

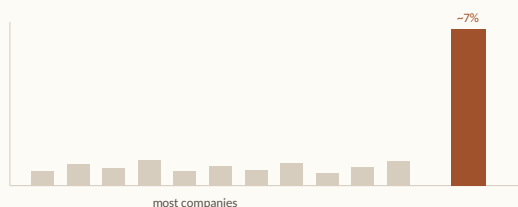
Tails, You Win

A small number of events account for the majority of outcomes — it's normal for most of what happens in investing to come from a tiny fraction of events.

Housel walks through Heinz Berggruen's art dealership, in which the overwhelming majority of the collection's eventual value came from a small handful of the artists he'd invested in, while most of the rest performed unremarkably or lost money. This "tail-driven" pattern, he argues, describes almost everything in investing and business: **you can be wrong half the time and still make a fortune, because the rare huge winner more than covers the many modest losers.**

~7%

Of the roughly 1,600 companies Housel cites in the Russell 3000 index responsible for essentially all of the index's net gain over multiple decades — the rest, in aggregate, were worthless or negative



A SMALL SHARE OF COMPANIES ACCOUNT FOR ESSENTIALLY ALL OF THE INDEX'S NET GAIN

He extends this to venture capital, where a firm's whole fund can be justified by a single Google or Amazon-scale winner, and to personal decision-making, where a handful of "fat tail" choices — who you marry, which career you pick, whether you buy a

home before a boom — will outweigh most of your other decisions combined.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel wants you to expect and accept a high failure rate as normal, not a sign you're doing something wrong — the object is not to avoid every bad pick, but to stay in a position where you're exposed when the rare huge win arrives. He is explicit that this means not pulling out of long-term positions out of frustration with a string of ordinary or losing periods.

Freedom

The highest dividend money pays is the ability to control your own time.

Housel cites research finding that having a sense of control over one's life is a more dependable predictor of feeling happy than almost any other measurable factor, income included. Money's greatest intrinsic value, in his account, is not the stuff it can buy — it's that it buys you the ability to wake up and decide what to do with your day, and to say no to things you don't want to do.

He traces the history of working hours across the 20th century — as incomes rose, so did the expectation of longer working hours and higher consumption, which meant that for many people rising income never actually converted into more autonomy. **The ability to do what you want, when you want, for as long as you want, has an infinite return on investment.**

Controlling your time is the highest dividend money pays.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel asks you to evaluate financial decisions by how much autonomy over your own time they buy you, not only by the income or lifestyle they buy. He frames this as a reason to value savings and independence over visible consumption — the freedom is the actual return.

Man in the Car Paradox

No one is as impressed by your possessions as you are — people use others' spending as a benchmark for their own desired status, not as a reason to admire the spender.

When you see someone driving an expensive car, Housel observes, you rarely think "what an impressive person" — you more often think about yourself driving that car, and how you would be seen in it. **The person who owns the car is, ironically, mostly invisible in this fantasy.** The paradox is that people who buy visible luxury in pursuit of admiration usually receive less of it than they expect, because observers are busy imagining themselves, not admiring the owner.

This connects to Housel's broader point about wealth signalling: if your goal in spending is genuinely to be respected or admired by others, humility, kindness, and empathy tend to earn you more of that respect than any purchase can.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel's advice is direct: if admiration is the actual goal behind a purchase, recognise that spending rarely buys it — people are using your possessions as a benchmark for their own wants, not as a reason to think highly of you. He suggests redirecting that impulse toward traits that do earn genuine respect.

Wealth Is What You Don't See

Wealth is the nice car not purchased — it is the financial assets that have not yet been converted into things you can see.

Housel draws a sharp line between being rich and being wealthy. Rich is a visible, current income that lets you spend on visible things. **Wealth is hidden — it's the income you didn't convert into stuff, sitting unseen as savings and investments.** Because wealth is invisible by definition, we tend to underestimate how much of it other people actually have, and to build our own aspirations around the visible spending of people who may have very little actually saved.

Spending money to show people how much money you have is the fastest way to have less money.

He notes this is why so many people who appear rich are in fact walking a financial tightrope — the visible signals of wealth (the car, the house, the vacations) are often purchased with the income that would otherwise have become wealth, leaving little cushion behind the display.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel wants you to stop using other people's visible spending as your gauge of what wealth looks like, and to recognise that real wealth is the accumulation you never see — including your own, if you're building it. The prescription is to value what you've chosen not to spend as much as what you have.

Save Money

Building wealth has little to do with your income and everything to do with your savings rate — which is entirely within your control.

You do not need a specific reason to save, Housel argues — saving just to save, as a hedge against a future you cannot predict, is reason enough. He rejects the idea that saving only makes sense when it's aimed at a defined goal like a house or retirement; unplanned, unattached savings give you optionality and flexibility precisely because you don't know what you'll need it for.

Your savings rate is one of the few parts of your financial life you have full control over — you cannot control market returns, but you can control how much of your income you choose not to spend. Housel argues this makes savings rate, not investment brilliance, the more reliable lever for most people to build wealth.

O

Specific purchases or goals required to justify saving money, in Housel's view — flexibility against an unknown future is reason enough on its own

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel prescribes increasing your savings rate without needing a specific goal attached to it, and treating that rate — not your income level or your investment picks — as the primary lever you pull to build wealth over time.

Reasonable > Rational

Aim for financial decisions you can stick with emotionally, not decisions that are coldly optimal on paper.

Housel cites research on why people pay off low-interest mortgages early even though the math says they'd come out ahead investing that money instead. The mathematically "rational" move and the emotionally sustainable move are not always the same move — and he sides with the second one.

Aiming for "reasonable" — a strategy you can realistically stick with through both good years and terrifying ones — beats aiming for the theoretically optimal strategy that you'll abandon the first time it hurts. A slightly lower-return plan you hold onto forever will outperform a higher-return plan you panic-sell out of at the worst moment.

A strategy that can't survive your own emotions won't survive the market.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel's instruction is to choose the financial strategy you can honestly say you'll still be following in twenty years, even when it's not doing well — and to favour that over a strategy that only works if you behave like an emotionless calculator.

Surprise!

History is used as a map for the future, but it overlooks its own biggest lesson: the largest events are always the ones no one saw coming.

Housel points to the 2008 financial crisis and its root causes as an event essentially no forecaster predicted in its specific shape — not because forecasters were careless, but because the conditions that caused it hadn't existed in that combination before. He argues history is a useful study of how people respond to risk and greed in general, but a poor guide to predicting the next specific surprise, precisely because the biggest events are outliers relative to everything that came before them.

The further back you look for lessons, the more general — and the less specifically predictive — those lessons should be. He warns against over-relying on precise historical data (like exact return sequences) as a forecast, while still valuing history's broader lessons about human behaviour under uncertainty.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel wants you to study history for how people behave — panic, greed, overconfidence — rather than mining it for a specific playbook of what will happen next. Expect to be surprised, and build that expectation into your planning rather than treating the past as a script for the future.

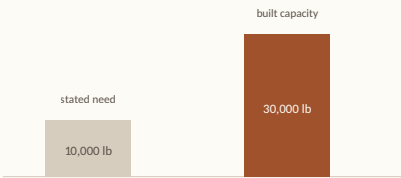
Room for Error

Planning for things not going as planned is the only way to keep a plan alive.

Housel uses the analogy of a bridge engineer who is told a bridge needs to hold 10,000 pounds and builds it to hold 30,000 — not because they expect the extra load, but because they know their own estimate could be wrong. **A margin of safety, applied to your finances, is what allows you to survive being wrong**, and being wrong, he argues, is close to inevitable over a long enough timeline.

3x

Roughly the safety margin the bridge-engineering analogy uses — built capacity versus the stated requirement — as the model for margin of error in personal financial planning



THE BRIDGE-ENGINEERING ANALOGY: BUILT WELL BEYOND THE STATED REQUIREMENT

He distinguishes room for error from pessimism: it isn't about assuming the worst will happen, it's about surviving if it does, so you can keep playing long enough for the good outcomes to eventually show up. This connects back to the book's recurring emphasis on survival as the master financial skill.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel prescribes deliberately building a bigger margin of safety into your financial plans than your best-guess scenario would suggest you need — enough room that being wrong about the future doesn't take you out of the game entirely.

You'll Change

Long-term financial planning is harder than it looks because your own goals and desires will change — don't overcommit to a single fixed path.

People consistently underestimate how much they will change in the future, even while readily acknowledging how much they've already changed in the past — a pattern Housel calls, following the psychological research he cites, the "end of history illusion." We plan our finances as though the person we are today is the person we will always be.

Because your goals at twenty are unlikely to be your goals at forty or sixty, financial plans built around permanent, unchanging desires are fragile. Housel argues for avoiding extreme, irreversible financial commitments made in service of a version of yourself you may not remain — and for accepting some regret and course-correction as a normal part of a long financial life, rather than a sign of failure.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel's advice is to avoid financial planning extremes — decisions so irreversible or so all-in on a single goal that they leave no room for the fact that you, and what you want, will keep changing. Build in room to change course.

Nothing's Free

Every field has a price for success — volatility and loss are the price of admission for investing returns, and the trick is deciding if that price is worth paying.

Housel frames stock market volatility not as a fine you pay for making a mistake, but as the entrance fee for the returns the market offers — the same way an entrance fee at a theme park isn't a punishment, it's simply the cost of getting in. **Investors who try to get the returns without accepting the volatility are, in effect, trying to get in without paying.**

Volatility is the fee, not the fine.

He argues that people who understand this framing hold on through downturns more easily, because they've already mentally accepted the cost as part of the deal, rather than experiencing every drop as a broken promise or a sign something has gone wrong.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel wants you to reframe market volatility, before it happens, as an expected fee rather than a punishment — and to decide in advance whether the long-run returns are worth that fee, so the next downturn doesn't feel like a reason to flee.

You & Me

Bubbles form when short-term traders' price signals overwhelm the market and long-term investors start playing the short-term traders' game.

Housel argues that a huge amount of investing confusion comes from different investors, with entirely different time horizons and goals, all watching the same price and drawing the same signal from it — even though a day-trader's reason for buying and a retirement saver's reason for buying should have nothing to do with each other.

When long-term investors start taking their cues from short-term traders' price action, a bubble is often the result — everyone begins reacting to the same signal for reasons that don't actually apply to them, and the price becomes disconnected from any underlying value that a long-term holder should care about.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel's instruction is explicit: know your own time horizon and stay disciplined to it, rather than reacting to price moves that are actually signals meant for investors playing an entirely different game than you are.

The Seduction of Pessimism

Pessimism sounds smarter and more compelling than optimism, even though optimism is the more historically accurate bet.

Pessimistic forecasts get more attention and sound more intellectually serious, Housel observes, because bad news tends to arrive suddenly and dramatically, while good news accumulates slowly and undramatically in the background — so pessimism always feels more urgent, even when the long-run data favours optimism.

Because progress happens too slowly to notice while setbacks happen fast enough to dominate the headlines, our intuitive sense of the trend is biased toward gloom — even in a world, and a market, that has trended upward across long stretches of history.

Optimism sounds like a sales pitch. Pessimism sounds like someone trying to help you.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel wants you to notice the credibility bias pessimism enjoys, and to correct for it deliberately — recognising that the long, undramatic accumulation of growth is real even though it never sounds as urgent as the case for disaster.

When You'll Believe Anything

We are drawn to overconfident stories that fill the gaps in our knowledge and make a chaotic world feel understood.

Housel argues that when we don't fully understand something — and no one fully understands where the market or the economy is headed — we reach for a confident narrative to fill that gap, because uncertainty is uncomfortable and a story, even a wrong one, is not. **The more emotionally compelling a financial story is, the less scrutiny people tend to apply to whether it's actually true.**

This is why financial forecasts delivered with total confidence attract believers even when the forecaster has no better track record than a coin flip — the confidence itself, not the accuracy, is what people are responding to.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel's prescription is to be suspicious of your own attraction to confident, tidy financial narratives, especially in moments of uncertainty — and to remember that the appeal of a story is not evidence of its truth.

All Together Now

A short recap, pulling the book's eighteen behavioural lessons into one place before the closing chapter.

Housel closes the main body of the book by briefly restating the core instinct behind each preceding chapter — try to be humble about your own success and empathetic toward others' failures, since luck and risk play a bigger role than any of us like to admit; save without needing a specific reason; give yourself more room for error than feels necessary; and hold onto a long time horizon, because time is where compounding does its real work.

The connecting thread across every chapter, restated here, is that behaviour — not intelligence, not technical knowledge — is what separates people who do well with money from people who don't. Housel doesn't introduce new material in this chapter; its role is to show how each individual lesson feeds the same theme.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

This chapter is a synthesis rather than a new prescription. What the author wants you to notice is how the eighteen individual ideas are really one idea, seen from different angles — and to carry that single behavioural thread forward, rather than treating any one chapter as a standalone rule.

Confessions

Housel closes by showing, not telling — laying out his own household's financial choices as the book's principles applied in practice.

Housel describes his own family's approach: a home bought with a fixed-rate 30-year mortgage after a large down payment, made deliberately more conservative than the couple could technically have afforded, and a savings rate that stays high regardless of income changes. He and his wife hold a significant portion of their savings in cash — not because he expects to need it for anything specific, but for the flexibility and room for error it provides, and for the ability to sleep at night regardless of what markets do.

His stated financial goal is independence — the ability to do what he wants, when he wants, with whom he wants, for as long as he wants — which is the book's "Freedom" chapter applied directly to his own life. He is explicit that this personal approach is not offered as advice for the reader to copy; it is offered as an example of one person's reasonable, not necessarily optimal, response to the ideas in the book.

WHAT THE AUTHOR WANTS YOU TO DO WITH THIS

Housel is explicit here: he is not telling you to copy his choices. What he wants you to do is build your own version of "reasonable" — a set of financial decisions shaped by your own personal history and temperament, the same way his are shaped by his, rather than by anyone else's optimal formula.

QUESTIONS TO THINK ABOUT

- 1** What specific decade and set of experiences shaped your own beliefs about what money can and can't do for you?
- 2** Where in your own financial history have you credited skill for something that was actually luck, or blamed a bad decision for something that was actually risk?
- 3** What would "enough" actually look like for you, stated as a specific number or condition, rather than left as a moving target?
- 4** Where in your life have you optimised for the highest possible return instead of the return you could actually sustain for decades?
- 5** What would it mean, concretely, to plan your finances around surviving rather than around winning?
- 6** How much of your visible spending has been shaped by a desire to be admired, and how has that spending actually been received by others?
- 7** What is the difference, in your own life, between being rich and being wealthy?
- 8** What would you have to give up, or accept, to raise your savings rate — and what is stopping you from doing it without a specific goal attached?
- 9** Is your current financial strategy one you can honestly say you'll still be following twenty years from now, even through a bad stretch?

- 10** What financial commitments have you made that assume you will want the same things in twenty years that you want today?
- 11** Where have you mistaken a confident financial story for a true one, simply because it was told with certainty?
- 12** What would your own "Confessions" chapter say — what reasonable, imperfect choices have you actually made, and why do they make sense for you?